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The Pandit and the President (1956–1958)

> *It speaks much for the latent strength of Indo-US friendship that the stresses and strains of the international crises in 1958 and storms in [the] UN did not cause any basic adverse effects on Indo-US friendly relations in spite of the known divergencies [sic] in outlook. The tendencies in the past which have cast considerable doubts and suspicions on the ability of the "two largest democracies in the world" to co-operate were not only kept in check but were materially reduced in influence.*
>
> —Annual Political Report for 1958 from Embassy of India, Washington, DC[1]

> *It was also dawning on America that in a war of ideas or ideologies, India was the strongest "ally" in a strategic region of the world not because India had announced this alliance, nor that India had signed any treaty, but that India existed and continued to grow as a thriving Democratic State.*
>
> —Annual Political Report for 1959 from Embassy of India, Washington, DC[2]

By the time Nehru traveled to the US in December 1956, there was greater convergence or at least parallelism in American and Indian views than there had ever been. And between 1956 and 1962, Delhi's perception of China